

THE D12 SYSTEM

Coyote & Crow uses a system of dice rolls, called Checks, to determine the outcome of many story events. The Story Guide will determine when dice need to be employed. In this chapter, we'll talk about what dice the Players and Story Guide will use, how to apply them, and what the numbers mean.

If you've never played a roleplaying game before, dice are used to determine the results of situations where your Character's agency isn't a factor. That is to say, you don't use dice to determine if your Character fires a bow, but only to determine whether or not they hit their target and to what effect. Similarly, the Story Guide will use dice to determine the results of the efforts of the non-Player Characters, but not their actions. A Story Guide may choose to have a bear attack a Character, but

the dice will determine whether or not that big furry paw injures the Character.

As with all rules in Coyote & Crow, there are times to ignore them. If the dice are ever getting in the way of telling a good story, the Story Guide and Players are free to talk about when to override them or not use them, with the Story Guide always being the final arbiter. The dice are tools of surprise, suspense, and excitement. They are not meant to hold back your game. When they don't serve your group's needs, set them aside as necessary. Some of the best moments in roleplaying games have nothing to do with dice, but instead have to do with brilliant moments of dialogue and interplay between Players, Story Guides, and the Characters they've created.

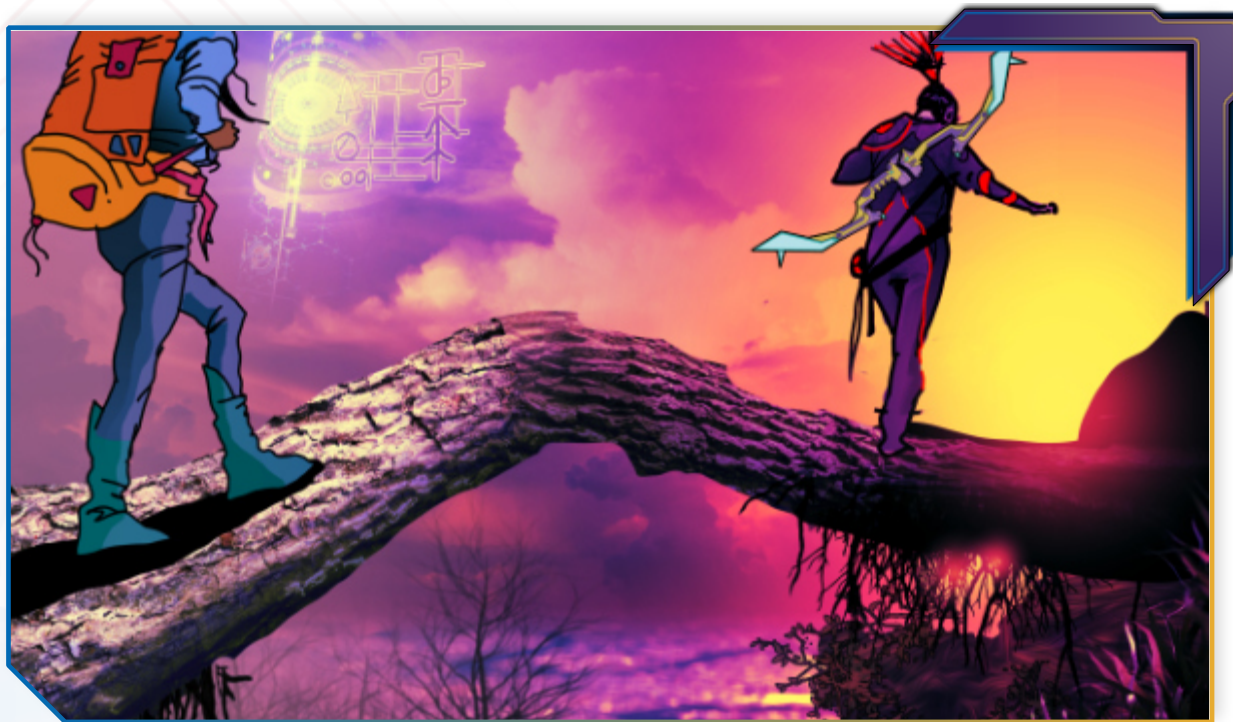
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That said, the D12 System for Coyote & Crow allows for a consistent framework for Players to understand the capabilities of their Characters and the challenges they face. As the name implies, you'll be using a single kind of die, a d12 (a die with numbers ranging from 1-12). You'll often be rolling multiple D12s at the same time and these groups of dice are referred to as a Dice Pool (even if it's just one d12).

Whenever a Story Guide or Player puts together a Dice Pool and they want to determine the outcome of an attempted action, this is called a Dice Check or just a

Check. Generally, the Story Guide decides when a Check is required from anyone, but Players are also encouraged to ask their Story Guides if they can make a Check.

We recommend each Player and the Story Guide have their own set of dice if possible. A standard set of dice to start with would be 9 white d12s and 3 black d12s. While you occasionally need more than that, this number should be a good starting place. You can find twelve-sided dice at your local hobby game store or at multiple places online if a hobby store isn't nearby. Our suggestion is that they be white and black, as these



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work best for those with color related vision impairments, but they can be any two distinct colors that your group agrees upon.

If you're having trouble finding physical dice, a dice simulator is available for free through our mobile app. You can find it for Android or iOS by searching for "Coyote & Crow".

Dice Checks

Most of what you do with dice in Coyote & Crow will be called Dice Checks, Checks or "making a check", which all have the same meaning. There is a very specific structure to making a Check.

Below is a quick list of the steps to a Check, followed by a detailed breakdown of each step.

Steps to Making A Dice Check

- Create a Dice Pool
- Determine Success Number
- Roll Dice Pool
- (Optional) Use Legendary Status
- (Optional) Use Focus
- (Optional) Roll Critical Dice
- Determine Success or Failure

Creating Dice Pools

Most Dice Pools in Coyote & Crow are created when a Character attempts to use a Skill, Stat, or Ability to accomplish something.

For the vast majority of Dice Pools you create, you'll be rolling Standard, white dice. In fact, it's so prevalent to roll Standard dice, that if a rule or description doesn't mention a color or type of dice explicitly, they are by default Standard (white) dice.

A Dice Pool is any number of dice collected and rolled together for the purpose of determining the outcome of a Check. The number of dice used in a pool is determined by what the Character is trying to do and generally falls into these categories:

- Abilities
- Skills
- Stats

There are a handful of other possibilities, such as Reaction Rolls, but we'll cover those later. For now, let's focus on the main three you'll likely be using.

For Abilities, simply refer to the details of the specific Ability to

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determine what dice should be used in the pool. The Ability will detail which dice, often based on Stats, apply to the Dice Pool. For example, if an Ability says to create a Dice Pool based on the Character's Spirit and Wisdom, and the Character has a Spirit of 2 and a Wisdom of 3, the Dice Pool would be 5 dice.

For Skills, you'll use the Character's Skill Rank, plus a Related Stat and other modifiers, such as those given by equipment. Each Skill has two Related Stats. If the Character has at least 1 Rank in a Skill, then the Player uses the higher of the two Related Stats. If the Character has a 0 Rank in a Skill then they use the lower of the two Related Stats. If the Skill has an asterisk (*), the Character cannot use the Skill at Rank 0.

Example: Aya has an Agility of 3 and a Perception of 2 and wants to use her Ranged Weapons Skill of 2. She adds 2 dice from the Ranged Weapons Skill and 3 dice from her Agility skill, for a Dice Pool of 5 dice. She also adds any dice she received from the ranged weapon she is using. If Aya had no Ranks in the Ranged Weapons Skill, she would add 0 from

Ranged Weapons and use her Perception of 2, the lower Stat, for a total Dice Pool of 2.

As you can see, being trained in a Skill makes you vastly more adept than someone untrained. Although it is stated in the Equipment section, it's important to reiterate that you cannot add more dice to your pool from a piece of equipment than you have in the Skill. So if Aya has no Ranks in Ranged Weapons, she adds no bonus dice from the weapon to her Dice Pool. With a Ranged Weapons Rank of 2, she can add up to 2 dice from the weapon bonus.

For Stats, you refer to the individual Stat and that number is your Dice Pool. It's important to note that Players do not initiate Stat Checks. If a Player wanted to attempt to lift something, they would use their Athletics Skill, not their Strength. Only Story Guides call for Stat Checks based on specific circumstances, often Reaction Rolls.

That's it. You've created a Dice Pool.

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Determine Success Number

The Success Number is what you'll need to roll on each die in your Dice Pool for that die to be considered a Success. Unless a Success Number is stated in the text, the default Success Number is 8. That means 8 or higher on an individual die is what you should be looking for.

Plenty of situations will alter that. In general, the Story Guide will determine your final Success Number, but here are some common situations that might either alter that default 8 or result in a different Success Number.

- An Ability lists a specific Success Number.
- A Skill lists a specific Success Number.
- Gear or Effects alter the Success Number.
- The environment or other Characters affect the Success Number.

In general, the Story Guide will assign a final number. Most of the time that number will be between 5 and 11. It can never go below 2. It can go above 12, but this doesn't happen often and will be explained below in Going Above 12.

Roll the Dice Pool

You have a pool of dice and you know your Success Number. It is time to roll those dice! Once you've rolled them, each die should be separated out into 1 of 4 categories. Success Numbers or higher, lower than the Success Number, 1's, and 12's. Each die that shows a Success Number or higher gives you 1 **Success**. Each number lower than the Success Number adds nothing to your roll but also doesn't take anything away. Each 1 you roll is considered a **Fail** and subtracts 1 Success.

Leave your dice as they are and move on to the next step.

(Optional) Use Legendary Status

This step is optional and only comes into play when a Character has at least 1 Legendary Rank. For every Legendary Rank a Character has, the Player may adjust the value of any die up or down by 1 point. They can adjust the same die more than once. They cannot change the value of a Fail. For example, Aya has a Dice Pool of 4, with a Success Number of 8. She has rolled the following die values: 1, 3, 7, 8. She has a Legendary

Rank of one and chooses to use her status to change the 7 to an 8, increasing it by one. Her Dice Pool is now: 1, 3, 8, 8.

Once a Player has spent all the Legendary Status that they wish to, move along to the next step.

(Optional) Use Focus

This step is optional. Focus represents a Character's sharpness of mind, their care, their attention to detail. It's that extra "hmm", before deciding a course of action or an extra breath before releasing an arrow. Focus represents the Character's ability to dial into a task and push away distractions.

At this stage in the Check, the Player may spend any number of points from Mind to adjust the value of any die that is not a Fail. For every point of Mind spent, one die may be adjusted upward or downward by one. Players may boost a die to 12 this way, but Fails may not be adjusted.

When the Player has spent all of the points of Mind that they wish, move on to the next step. Players should be aware that many Abilities cost Mind to activate and that mental attacks take Damage from Mind. If you spend too many

points on Focus, you may be making yourself vulnerable. It is possible to use Focus to reduce your Character's Mind to zero, causing them to fall Unconscious.

(Optional) Roll Critical Dice

This step only occurs if the Player either rolled at least one 12 or if they used Legendary Status or Focus to alter a die to a result of 12. For every die showing 12 in the Dice Pool, the Player should gather up an equal number of Critical (black) dice. They then roll that Critical Dice Pool and add the results to the original pool. Any number rolled on Critical Dice below the Success Number, even a 1, counts as one Success. Any Critical Die that rolls equal to or higher than the Success Number is worth two Successes. Critical Dice also follow these rules:

If equal to or higher than the Success Number, Effects are activated for certain gear. For example, Bleeding or Poison.

If a Player rolls a 12 or multiple 12s with their Critical Dice, they repeat the Critical Dice Step, creating a new Dice Pool with one Critical Die for each 12 that they rolled in the previous Critical Dice step.

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If a weapon or Skill or Ability doesn't specify an effect for a Critical Success then the Story Guide may apply a Story Event (see below).

Note that Focus and Legendary Status cannot be used on Critical Dice. Once all Critical Dice have been rolled and added to the original Dice Pool, carry on to the final step.

Determine Success Or Failure

You should now have a group of dice in front of you with varying numbers and you should have an idea of whether each of those dice adds or subtracts Successes — or does neither. Now all you need to do is add them all up. Add 1 for every Success, 2 for every Success on a Critical Dice and subtract 1 for every Fail on a Standard die. Any remaining dice do nothing. The results will fall into one of these categories:

- 1+ Successes: Success
- 0 Successes: Failure
- < 0 Successes: Critical Failure

Success

The Character has achieved what they set out to do, at least to some degree. The number of Successes determines the actual effect. Each Success adds to the Character's progress in some fashion. 1 Success when throwing a punch at a tough Warrior might technically be a Success, but it's likely the Warrior had a lot more than 1 Body. The hacker might have made progress in getting into that computer, but didn't break in fully. Few things a Character attempts will be determined by needing a single Success. Sometimes a Story Guide will provide a specific number of Successes necessary to fully accomplish something in a single round. Or, as in the case with combat, a Success is equal to a point of Damage. It may take multiple Rounds and many Successes (points of Damage) to take down a tough adversary.

Failure

The Character has not set out what they wanted to do. There is no harm done, but neither has there been any progress. The Ceremony did not have any effect, the computer is still just as inaccessible as before, and your arrow either missed or bounced off your

opponent's protection. Generally, whatever is being attempted can be attempted again in the following Round as long as the situation hasn't changed.

Critical Failure

Whenever the total Dice Pool reflects fewer than zero Successes, the Character has not only failed in their attempted Action, they have made things worse for themselves in some fashion. The Story Guide will determine what the result is and this is called a Story Event (see below). The results can vary from a Character dropping their weapon or being out of ammunition, to falling face first in front of your opponent, to endangering or harming your allies. It may also indicate that you have ruined chances to attempt the same thing again in the future. For the Hacking Skill, it might indicate you've been entirely locked out of the system.

The negative value of the Dice Pool does not affect the degree of misfortune visited upon the Character. In other words, if your total Dice Pool was -5 Successes, you would not be any worse off than if you had rolled -1 Successes. A Critical Fail is a Critical Fail.

Story Events

Any time a Player's Dice Check results in either a Critical Success or Critical Failure, there may be additional effects besides just the results as specified. If these aren't called out specifically in the description of the Ability, Skill or Equipment listing then the Story Guide can create a Story Event. These are bits of story flair that add to the events in a way that can create really memorable moments. If it's a Critical Failure on a combat Check, maybe the Character accidentally knocks over something flammable and starts a fire. If it's a Critical Success, perhaps they not only glean the knowledge they were trying to obtain, but learn something else entirely unrelated that leads them onto a new adventure.

Story Guides should be careful not to use Story Events as punishments but instead as incentives to add drama and excitement to the overall scenario. Remember that the Player who rolled a Critical Failure is probably already a little disappointed at the unfortunate die roll. There's no need to rub it in by humiliating them further. Instead, Story Events should simply ratchet up the tension in an Encounter.

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Let's recap the whole process in a more concise format.

Dice Check Quick Reference

1. Create a Dice Pool

- 1.a. For Abilities, follow the rules for the specific Ability, then go to step 2
- 1.b. For a Skill, use the following formula:
 - b.i. Skill Rank +
 - b.ii. Higher of Related Stats (Unless Skill Rank = 0, in which case, use the lower Related Stat) +
 - b.iii. Any additional dice modifiers (such as weapons)
 - b.iv. = Total Dice Pool

2. Determine Success Number

- 2.a. Default is 8
- 2.b. Can be modified by Skills, Abilities, States, Effects, Conditional Modifiers or the Story Guide.
- 2.c. Story Guide determines final Success Number

3. Roll Dice

- 3.a. Success Number or higher: 1 Success

3.b. Lower than Success Number: 0 Successes

3.c. "1" is a Fail: -1 Success

3.d. "12" is a Critical Success: 1 Success and activates Critical Die

4. (Optional) Use Legendary Rank

5. (Optional) Use Focus

6. (Optional) Resolve Critical Dice

- 6.a. For every "12" rolled or created through Legendary Rank or Focus, roll a Critical (Black) Dice Pool.
- 6.b. Each Critical die that rolls below the Success Number, add 1 Success to the Pool. For each Critical die that rolls equal to or higher than the Success Number, add 2 Successes to the Pool.
- 6.c. For each "12" rolled with a Critical Die, roll an additional Critical Die. Repeat until no more "12's" are rolled.

7. Determine Success or Failure

- 7.a. Calculate total number of Successes
 - a.i. 1+ Successes: Success
 - a.ii. 0 Successes: Failure
 - a.iii. < 0 Successes: Critical Failure

Example: Here we'll go over an example of a Dice Check, step by step.

- » Aten would like to use their Ranged Weapon Skill to attack an opponent. Aten has the Ranged Weapons Skill at Rank 4, an Agility of 4, and a Perception of 3. Their Dice Pool would be 8. (Skill Rank 4 + Agility 4)
- » The Story Guide says the Success Number is 9. (The target has a Physical Defense of 7 and has +2 from the Take Cover Secondary Action)
- » Aten rolls their Dice Pool and the numbers are: 1, 3, 3, 5, 7, 9, 10, 12.
- » Aten skips the Legendary Status stage because their Rank is 0.
- » Aten then decides to use Focus to spend 2 points of Mind to change the 7 to a 9
- » Their Dice Pool is now: 1, 3, 3, 5, 9, 9, 10, 12.
- » Aten adds 1 Critical Die (because of the 12) and rolls a 9. Their pool is now 1, 3, 3, 5, 9, 9, 10, 12, plus a 9 on a Critical Die.
- » Aten ends their Check with 5 Successes. They have 4 Stan-

dard Successes, and one Critical Success for a total of 6 Successes. They have 1 Fail. Subtracted from the 6 Successes, that leaves them with 5 Successes. Aten would hit their target and do 5 points of Body Damage with their Ranged Weapons attack.

Going Above 12

Sometimes Success Numbers can be higher than 12. It's not immediately obvious how anyone would roll higher than a "12" on a twelve sided dice and that's intentional. Story Guides should be very cautious about setting Success numbers at "13" or higher as these create extremely challenging situations for Players.

In the case of Success numbers higher than "12," Players must subtract one "12" from their final Dice Pool roll to add +1 to another "12" creating a "13." This means in order to roll above "12," the Player must roll at least two "12s."

These situations do not come up often and should not be taken lightly. If a Story Guide says you have a Success number of "13," you may want to consider other options before tackling that particular challenge.

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Skill Checks Over Time

Most of the time the actions of Characters in the world of Coyote & Crow have immediate results and consequences. This is especially true during Encounters where Characters take Actions that are resolved in the same Round they are initiated, whether it's throwing a punch, picking a lock, or getting information off of a computer.

But what about that overnight hack session? The entire afternoon you spent trying to convince that shopkeep to give up some in-

formation on someone you were tracking? The next day you spent tracking that target? How long do those take and when do you roll?

That's where Skill Checks Over Time come in. In situations where you wouldn't achieve immediate success, or that success is built upon smaller increments, you will use this modified version of the regular Skill Check. It is important to note the difference between Skill Checks Over Time and Contested Skill Checks. If someone (or something) is resisting the Skill involved and actively using the same Skill against the involved



Character, then use the rules for Contested Skill Checks. Skill Checks Over Time are used when it's only the Character's own limitations setting the pace.

Story Guides will ultimately decide when a Skill Check Over Time is called for. It's often called out directly in the descriptions of Abilities and Skills and these are some examples:

- Certain Skills like The Long Con
- The Crafting Skill
- Training animals with the Husbandry Skill
- Some uses of the Investigation Skill
- Researching or analyzing with the Science Skill
- The Gecko's Heart Ability when used out of an Encounter

So how exactly do Skill Checks Over Time (or SCOTs) work? There are generally two models that the Story Guides can pull from.

The first type of SCOT is about consistency over time. The Story Guide will pick (or the circumstances will determine) a set amount of time that the Character needs to gain at least one Success

on their Skill per interval. It might be ten hours with one check every hour. An hour is a great default interval if you just want to keep the story moving. Once each hour of in-game time, the Character makes a Skill Check. If they gain at least one Success, they'll be able to continue on to the next Check the following hour. If they make it through the final interval, they are done and they have accomplished what they set out to do.

These kinds of SCOTs are good for things like training an animal, long distance running, maintaining some piece of almost malfunctioning equipment, keeping a perimeter watch at night, or other instances where a Character is trying to do something relatively simple in a repetitive fashion.

The second type of SCOT is more demanding. Again, the Story Guide will set a time interval. It might be hours for something like repairing a piece of broken down farm equipment or a day for creating a new piece of art. When each interval is finished, the Character makes a Skill Check. Instead of simply trying for a Success, a certain total number of Successes must be achieved over the entire time period. This number is pre-deter-

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mined by the Story Guide and may or may not be communicated to the Player. The Successes gained during an interval are tracked and cumulative. Once the Character has obtained the total number of Successes needed, the job is done.

Going back to our broken down farm equipment example, the Story Guide might set a one hour interval and say to the Player that it looks like it will take about ten Successes (The Story Guide will have an exact number in mind, but doesn't have to divulge that to the Player). Each in-game hour, the Character will make a Skill Check with their Crafting Skill. Their first Check they get four Successes, the second hour they get three more. The third Check they get four Successes, bringing their total up to 11. The Story Guide confirms that that's enough and that they have repaired the item.

A Failure during an interval might mean no progress. Maybe the Character takes a break to clear their head and come back to it later. A Critical Failure might mean a setback, losing some previously gained Successes or even having to start from scratch.

As always, a good baseline for Success Numbers on these checks is 8.

However, these can easily be modified by circumstances and setting. Are they running in a snowstorm? Are they painting with bad tools? Are they repairing the equipment in a state of the art facility with the best tech available?

Invention

It is not often something is created that is truly new. Frequently, invention is about coming up with a better version of something that already exists, to improve on the current iteration. Yet sometimes, a completely new thing is brought into the world, and that can be a powerful event. While the following rules are written around the concept of inventing a new piece of technology, they can also be applied to almost anything totally new – discovering a new Ability, inventing a new ceremony, making a new chemical compound for gats.

First, invention should be something discussed with the Story Guide and parameters established. Certain inventions that a Player might have in mind might seriously alter the boundaries of the story and the world of Coyote & Crow itself. Could a Character invent a portal to another world? In theory, yes, but maybe that is something

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the Story Guide and the other Players don't want to dive into in this Saga. Discuss what you would like to invent with your group first if it's something new.

If you want to improve upon something that already exists, still talk with your Story Guide. Generally, an improvement on something existing — like a mag-bow that does more damage — won't have as drastic an impact on the world, but it might. If the Invention is doing something as simple as lowering a Success Number, as opposed to adding Dice to a Check, then the time taken to invent is likely much less. Someone with decent Crafting might be able to make a friend's personal mobility vehicle slightly more maneuverable, lowering Success Numbers on appropriate checks in days or maybe hours.

Whether you are improving something that already exists or bringing something entirely new into the world, you will be using the Skill Checks Over Time rules. However, this time the bar is set a little higher. After all, if you could simply sit down and create a new and better mag-bow, everyone would be doing it. First off, invention requires Critical Successes. Normal

Successes do not count toward invention. Second, the default Success Number is 12. This can be modified down under optimal circumstances — in a lab with top-of-the-line gear, with a team — but this should be done in moderation.

Second, both the interval and the total time should be scaled appropriately. If a Character is just trying to make their own personal mag-sling a little better and improve range or accuracy, maybe that takes six months. If they are trying to improve the very concept of mag-slings, that might take years.

Lastly, if a person wishes to invent something, in addition to the SCOT, the Player must also take it as a Long Term Goal. It often becomes the focus of a person's attention and will certainly eat up a majority of their free time. Inventions and the efforts to bring them to life can be the focus of great stories and whole Sagas even. Don't be afraid to expand the World of Coyote & Crow and make it your own.

A Final Rule

Bigots and racists are not allowed to play Coyote & Crow.